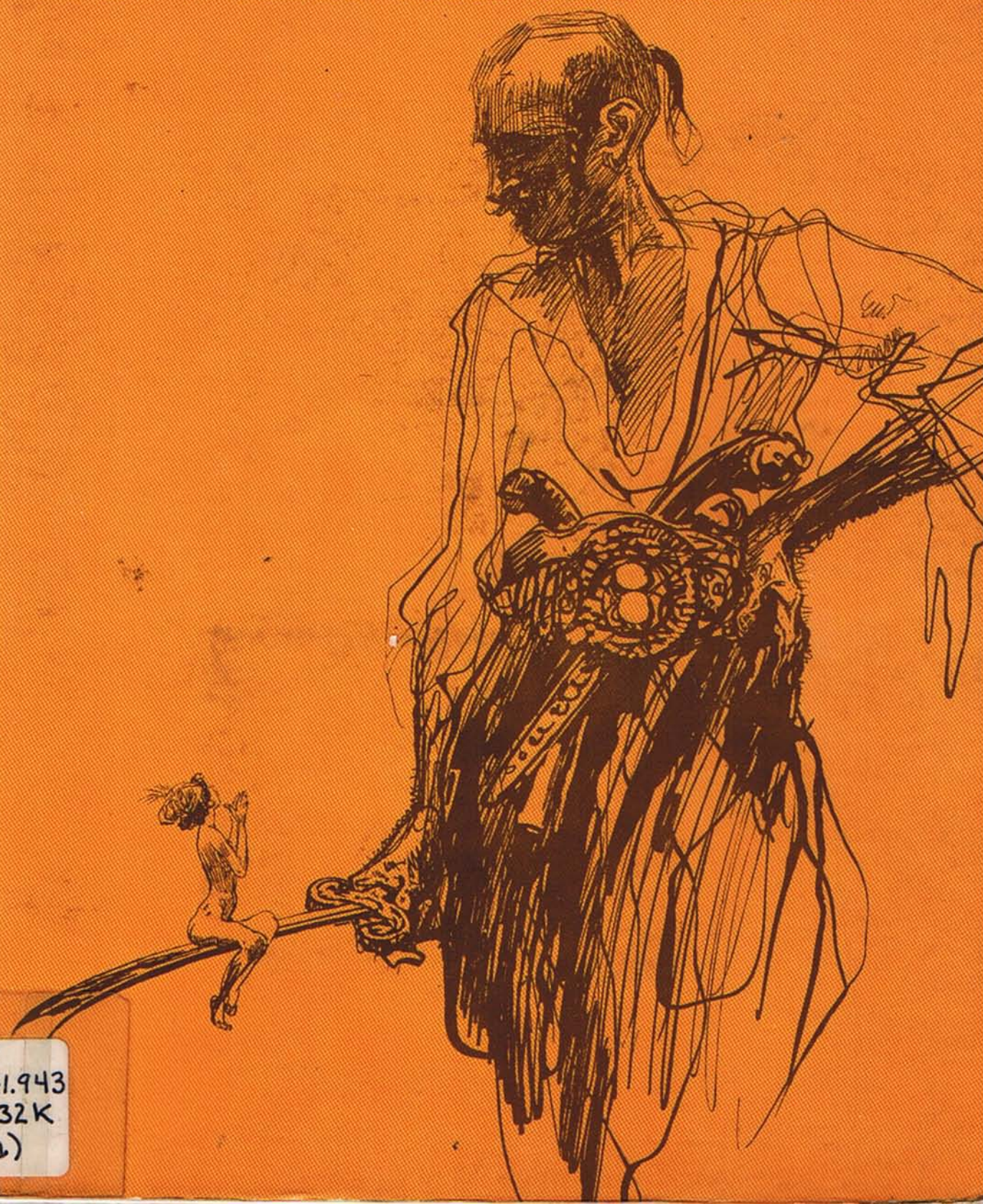


200 DRAWINGS

\$3.00

THE DRAWINGS OF HEINRICH KLEY



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(2)

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osity which his pen sketches show, he captured the disillusionment that was such a strong under-current in Germany (despite the war spirit which existed at other levels), and his jibes drew emotional resonance from his audience. He was a deft pricker of bubbles; even shocking in the expression of his perceptions. Social life, as illustrated by Kley, took on the quality of Restif de la Bretonne or Crebillon, and cruelty and pain and ironic laughter emerged unexpectedly in the jittery lines that crossed and intercrossed so individually.

Kley now started to divulge a world of metaphor and paradox as wildly bizarre as the visions of the elder Breughel or the animal scrolls of 13th century Japan, with both of which he has obvious affinities. Animals and monsters and weird emergences of bestiality from a human base all symbolized the various vices and follies that beset mankind: with virtues Kley had little concern.

At first glance we might think that Kley had some deep symbolism in mind, with his elephants, bird-women, satyrs, crocodiles, and assorted chimeras, but a closer examination shows that there are only a few elementary equations to be drawn: The following items, for example, are equal members of a long equation: elephants, babies and children, lubberliness, and coy, awkward innocence. (Elephants may have entered the equation because of their popularity in the advertising of his day.) Perhaps this equation is the reason that the picture of the elephant-seller arouses a feeling of horror and dismay in some viewers. Elsewhere, his symbolism is often traditional: the centaur usually equals lust, the faun or devil is usually to be found where human suffering is strong. Inversions of image are sometimes used, like racing snails, and puns and word and thought play find their place upon his paper. The erotic element is strong, and there is a certain infantile delight in words and utensils and postures suggestive of excretion—an obvious desire to shock at all costs.

As we glance back at these drawings from 1960, they now seem to be an integral part of the multi-channeled artistic outflow that was going on in Continental Europe in the 1910's and early 1920's. Kley lived in the same Munich that harbored Kandinsky, Klee, and the other Blue Riders. Yet despite coincidence in time and space, there seems to have been no social or artistic relationship between Kley and the modernists. Perhaps this was a difference of age: Kley

was now about 50, paunchy and solemn, according to a self-portrait of this time. Perhaps it was because Kley was more absorbed with the world of pain and revulsion than they were. Perhaps Kley, an astonishing draftsman whose animal sketches rank technically among the best, had little understanding and sympathy for the experiments of men who were far beneath him in technique.

This was Heinrich Kley during his last period of productivity, between 1908 and World War I; a mysterious satirist and satyr, who seems to have felt pain where others laughed, and laughed, not always pleasantly, where others were silent. We know nothing about him personally, beyond what can be guessed from the strange reversal in his life and the personality that emerges from his work. After the appearance of his books (*Skizzenbuch* [1909], *Skizzenbuch II* [1910], *Sammel-Album* [1923], *Leut' und Viecher* [1912] he only occasionally illustrated art books. In the March 1939 issue of *Gebrauchsgraphik*, however, Kley is referred to as an outstanding contemporary commercial artist. The article reproduces a delicately colored industrial scene from the Krupp plant and some pen and ink sketches—in sketch-book style—which he had drawn for the Minimax catalogue for the year. After this he drops out of sight.

Kley's work was very popular for a time, and each of his books—which contain both periodical illustrations and new work—went through several editions. It is easy to understand, however, why he and his work would have been feared and disliked in the Germany that was emerging in the third and fourth decades of the century. He is ignored in histories of the magazines to which he contributed, and is passed over in silence in books on the art movements of Munich, although many men of lesser ability are discussed.

Kley's death has been reported many times, so that it is not certain just when he actually did die. A rumor of his death in the early 1940's has been denied. According to some authorities he died on August 2, 1945; according to others, he died on February 8, 1952. Kley, who perpetually evoked the demonic and absurd in man, would have enjoyed this confusion.

New York
November, 1960

Dover Publications, Inc.

SKETCHBOOK
SKIZZENBUCH





The Tip II
Das Trinkgeld II





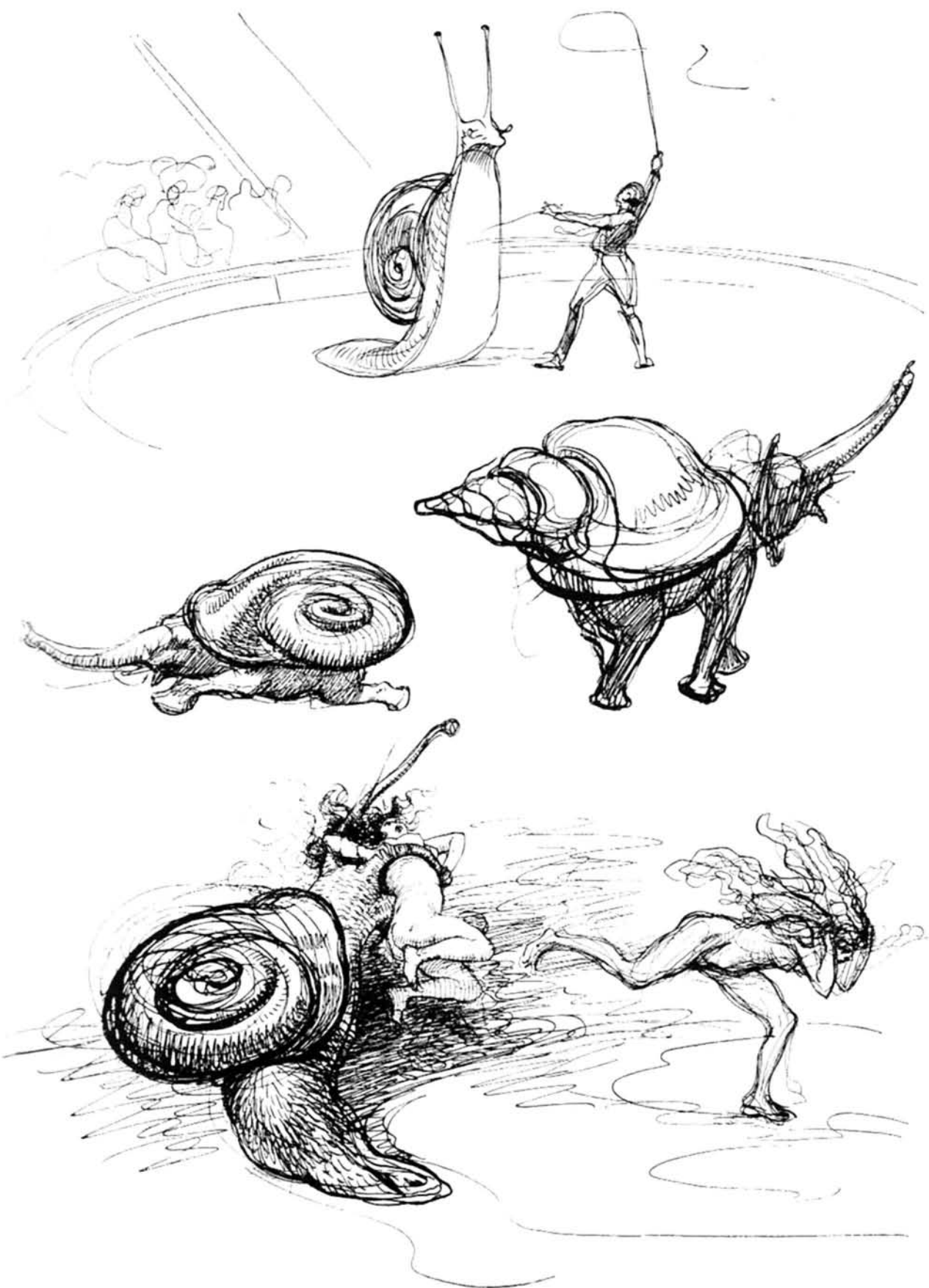
The Tip I
Das Trinkgeld I

SKETCHBOOK
One Hundred Pen Drawings
by
HEINRICH KLEY

SKIZZENBUCH
Hundert Federzeichnungen
von
HEINRICH KLEY



Wet Nurse to Elephants
Die Elefantenamme



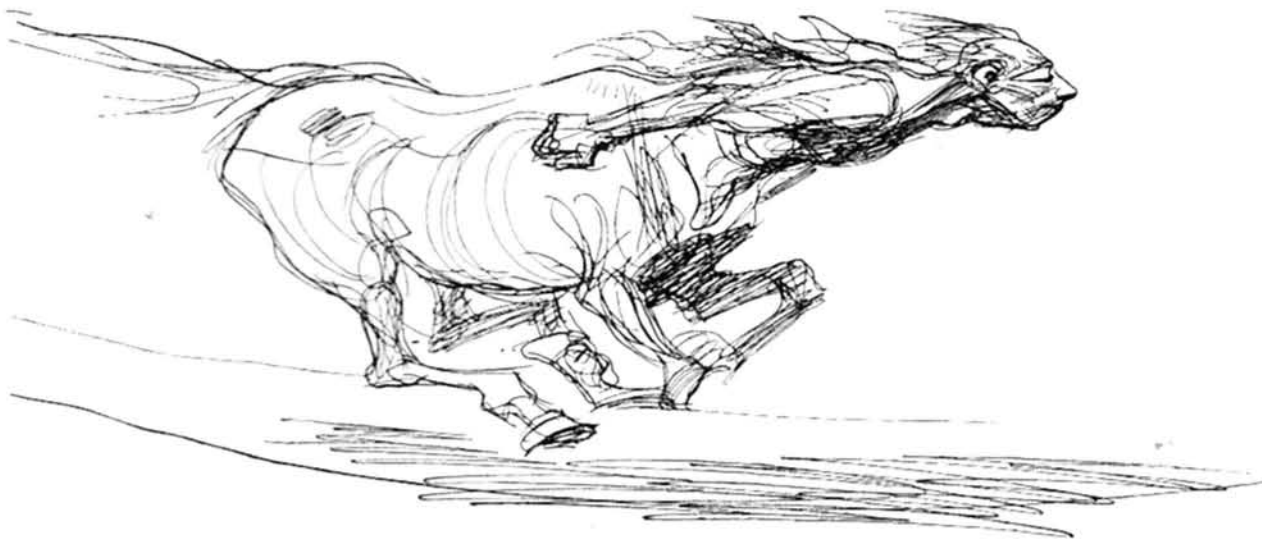


Love's Labor's Lost
Verlorene Liebesmüh





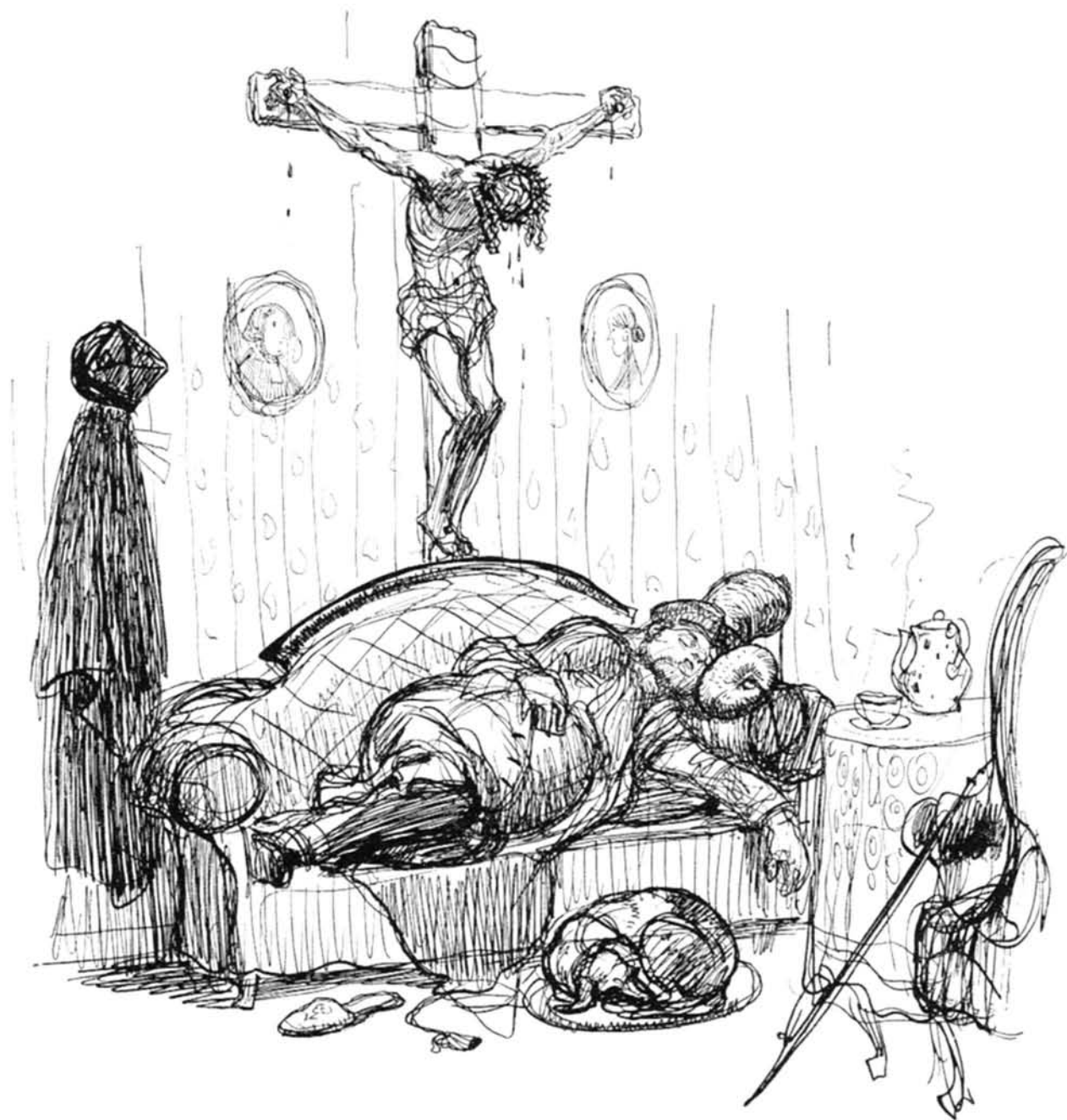
Springtime
Der Frühling





A Game of Diablerina
Diaballetteuse





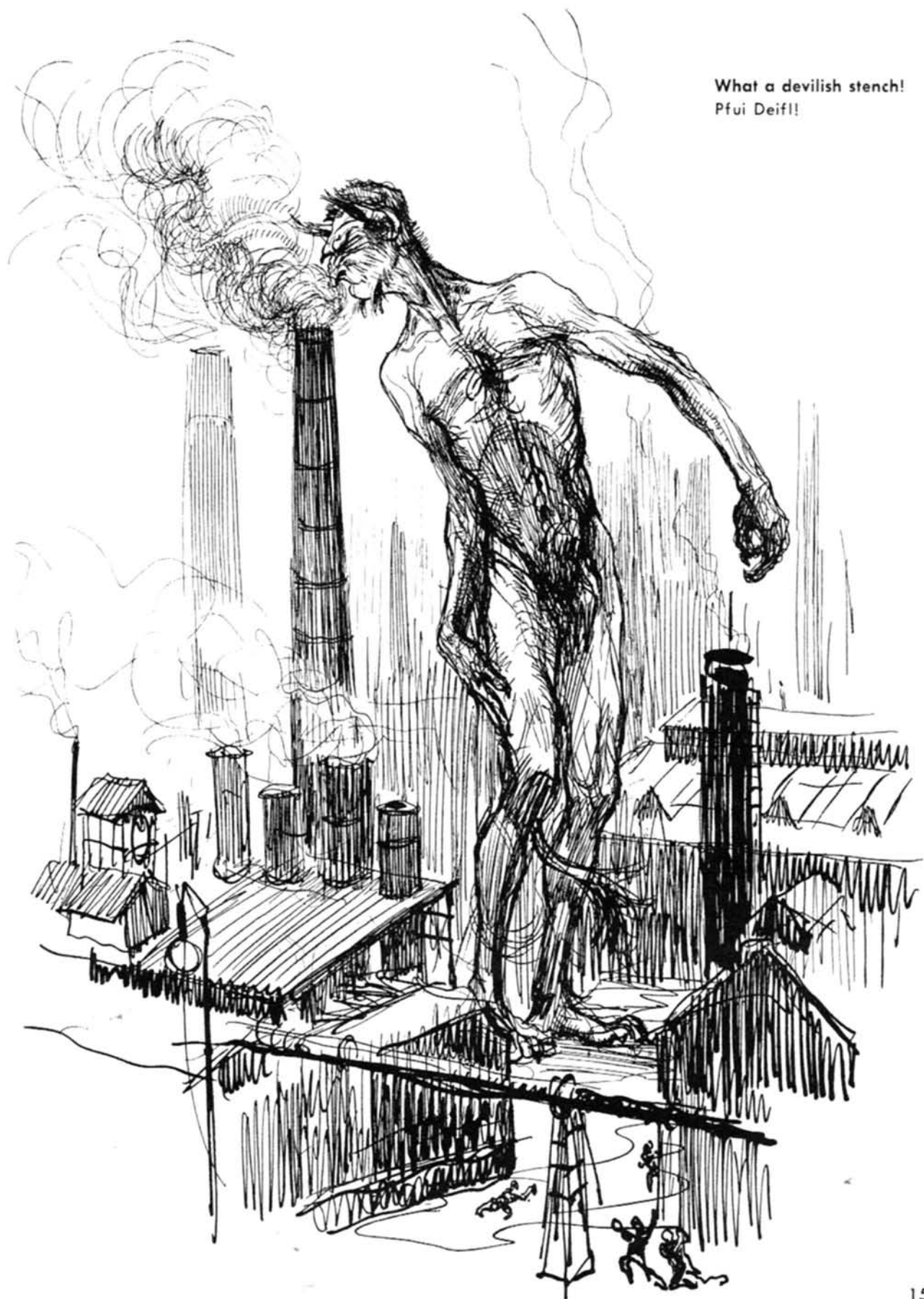
The pastor sleeps. The noontime meal
Was ample, and the day is hot.
And Karo too is stuffed from head to heel.
A comfort now prevails of sated glut.

But while the pastor's sleeping for the nonce
A dream approaches—horrid and abhorred:
That he was truly, all at once,
As poor as Jesus Christ, Our Lord.

Herr Pastor schläft. Das Mittagessen
War reichlich, und der Tag ist schwül.
Auch Karo hat sich vollgefressen.
Es herrscht ein sattes Wohlgefühl.

Indessen der Herr Pastor schlief,
Kommt ihm ein Traum, der schrecklich ist:
Dass er mit einmal effektive
So arm sei wie Herr Jesus Christ.

What a devilish stench!
Pfui Deifl!



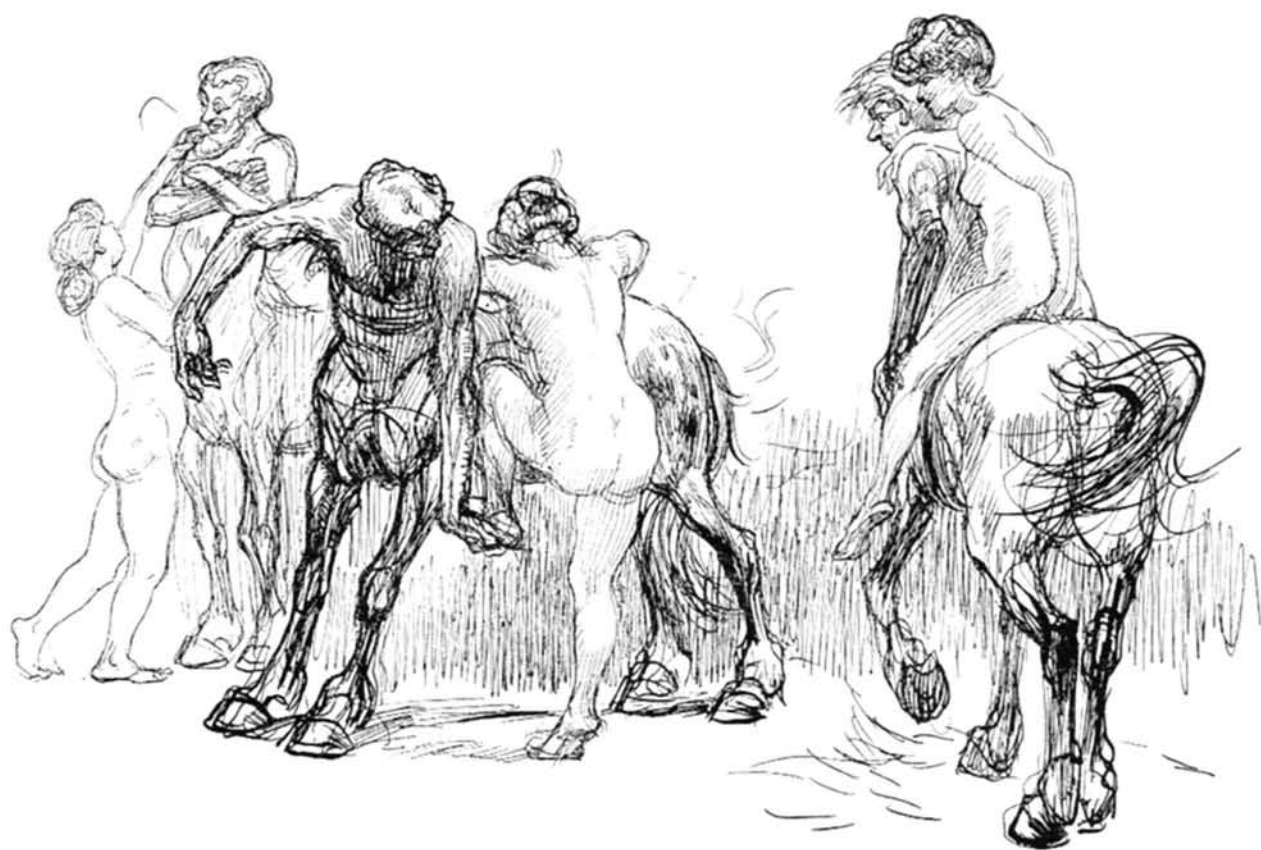




Committee for Public Morals
Die Sittenkommission



Sabotage
Betriebsstörung





Picnic
Picknick



The Ladies' Marching Band
Die Damenkapelle

His Most Exalted Highness
Serenissimus





Hey diddle!
Duliöh!





"And why shouldn't I play the guitar?"
"Warum soll denn ich nicht Guitarr spielen?"



"Sure I play the guitar. Now all the more!"

"Freilich spiel ich Guitarr. Jetzt erst recht!"

After the Ball
Nach dem Ball



Chamber Trio
Kammertrio





The Breastwork
Die Brüstung



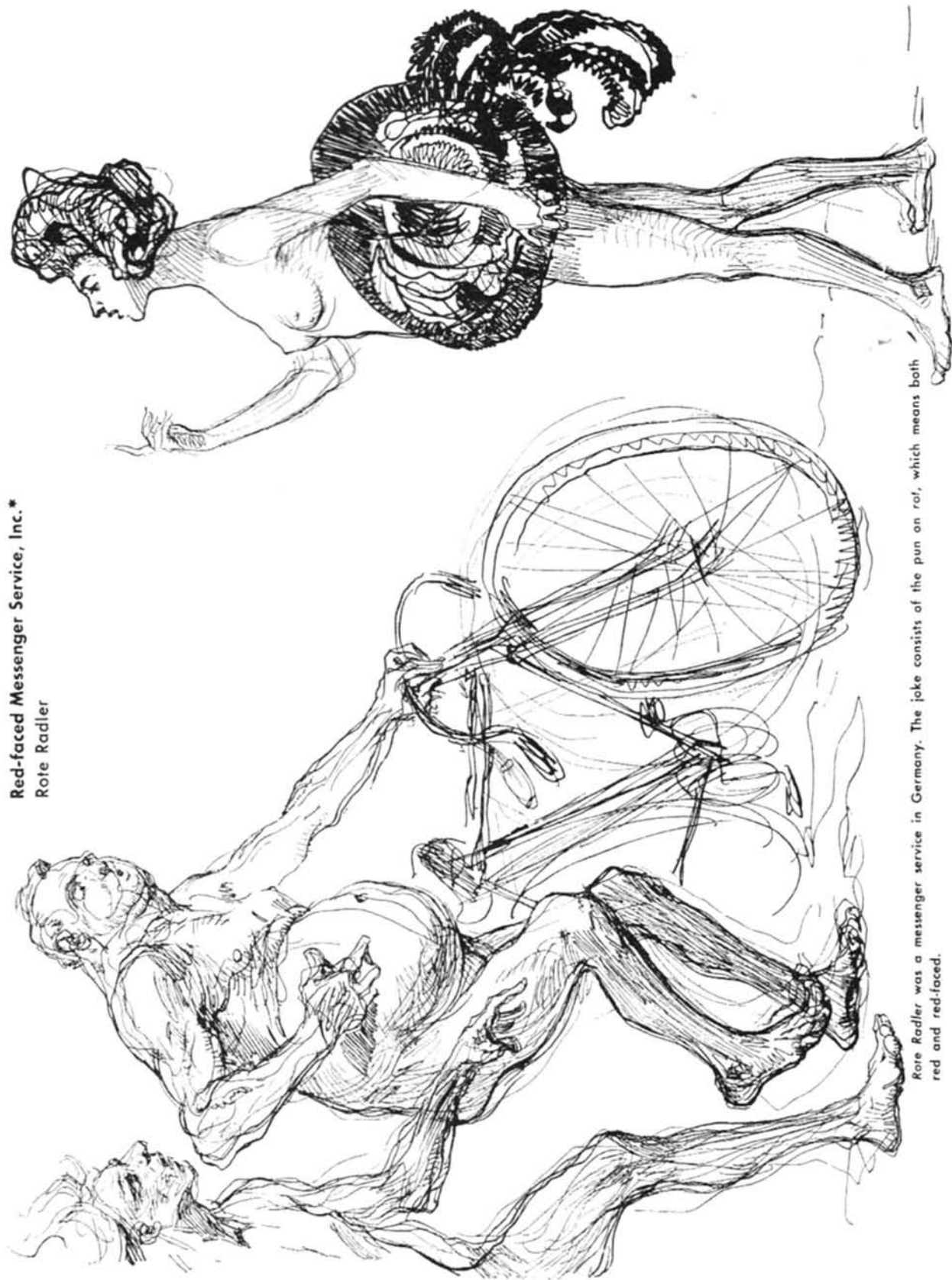


Quartet I
Quartett I



Quartet II
Quartett II

Red-faced Messenger Service, Inc.*
Rote Radler



Rote Radler was a messenger service in Germany. The joke consists of the pun on *rot*, which means both red and red-faced.





Asking for Her Hand
Die Werbung



Moving Day
Umzug







The Tenor
Der Tenor



The Airship
Das Luftschiff

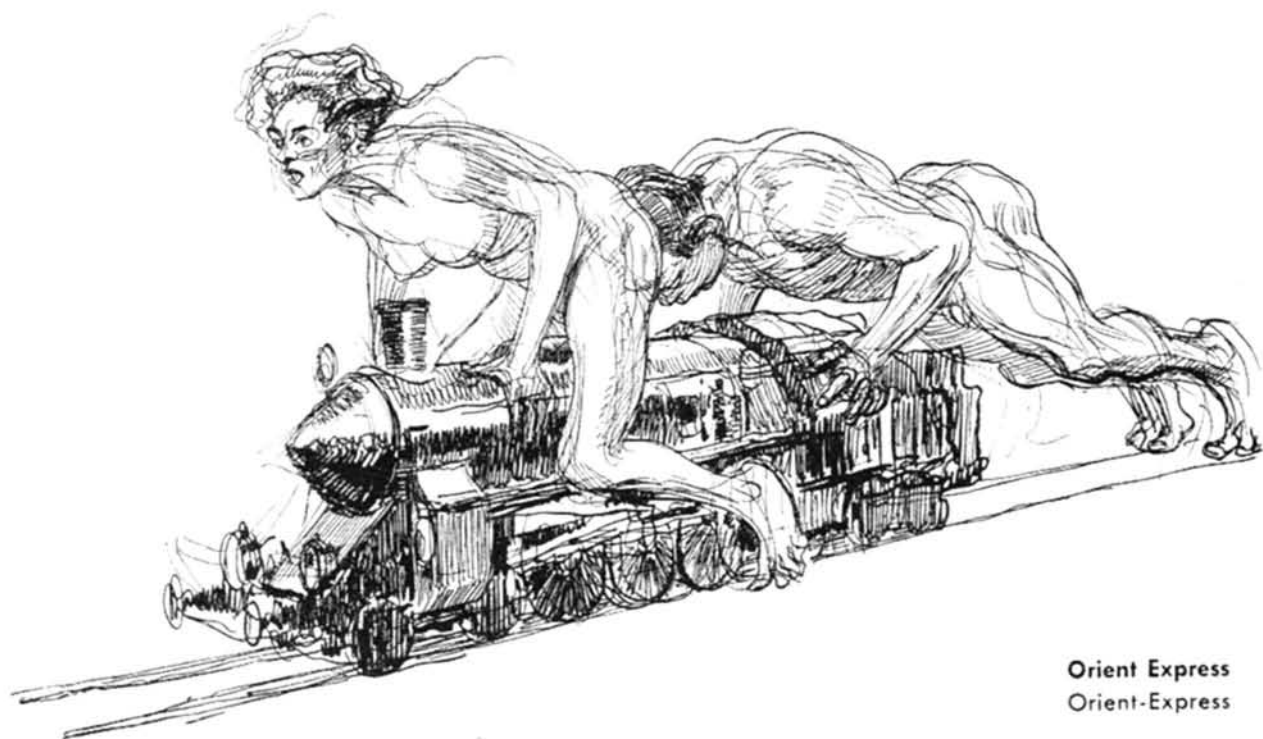


When a boy and a girl are in accord before God and have their little toothbrushes along, the whole world is theirs.

Wenn zwei vor Gott sich einig sind und ihre Zahn bürsten bei sich haben, gehört ihnen die ganze Welt.





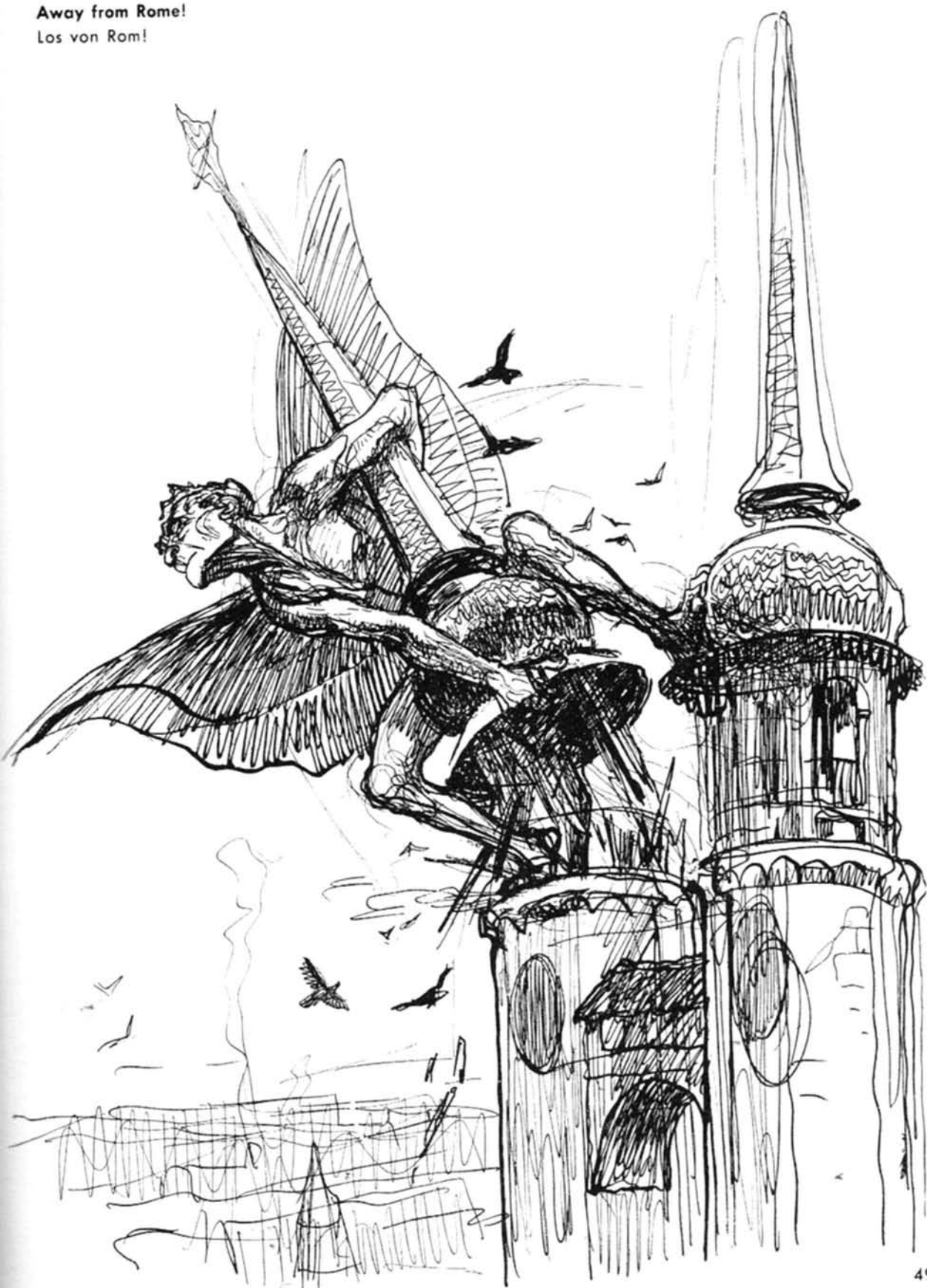


Orient Express
Orient-Express

✓
The Hygienic Sausage Factory
Die Hygienische Wurstküch



Away from Rome!
Los von Rom!





The Herr Schoolmaster
Der Herr Lehrer



Girl from Mimmenhaus
Mimmenhauserin

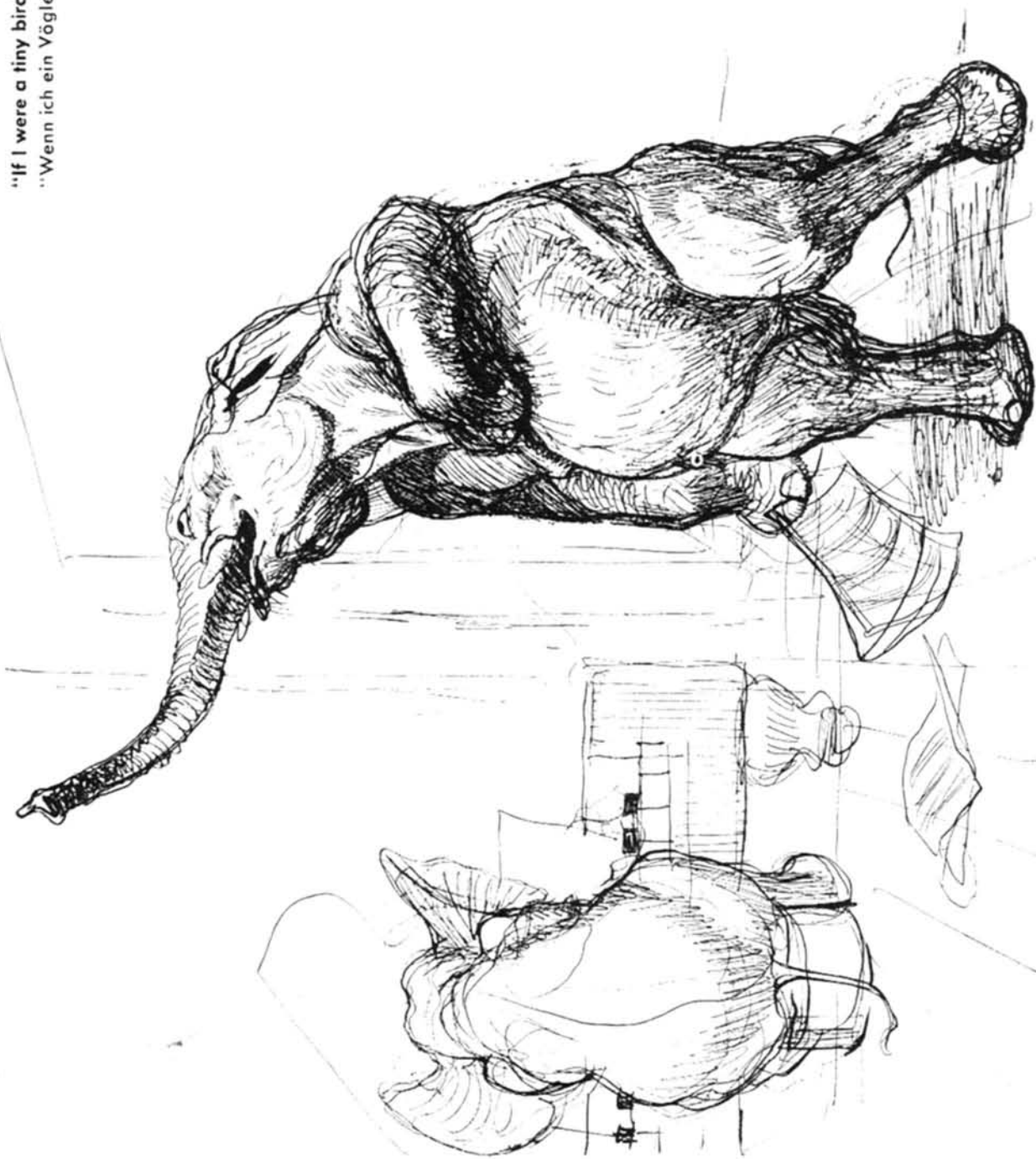
In Front of the Fireplace
Vor dem Kamin





The Patriot
Der Patriot

"If I were a tiny bird . . ."
"Wenn ich ein Vöglein wär . . ."





The Copyists
Die Kopisten



Idyll at the South Pole
Südpol-Idyll



A Love Story
Eine Liebesgeschichte







Doctor of Engineering
Dr. ing.



The Theater Director
Der Herr Direktor



Gallop to the Right
Rechtsgalopp

Recruits
Rekruten







SKETCHBOOK II

SKIZZENBUCH II





SKETCHBOOK II
One Hundred Pen Drawings
by
HEINRICH KLEY

SKIZZENBUCH II
Hundert Federzeichnungen
von
HEINRICH KLEY

Anthill
Ameisenhaufen





Decorate Your Home!
Schmücke dein Heim!



Mole and Purebred Pig
Maulwurf und Edelschwein



The Nursemaid
Das Kindsmädchen



Carnival
Fasching



The Battle-tested Veteran
Der schlachterprobte Veteran

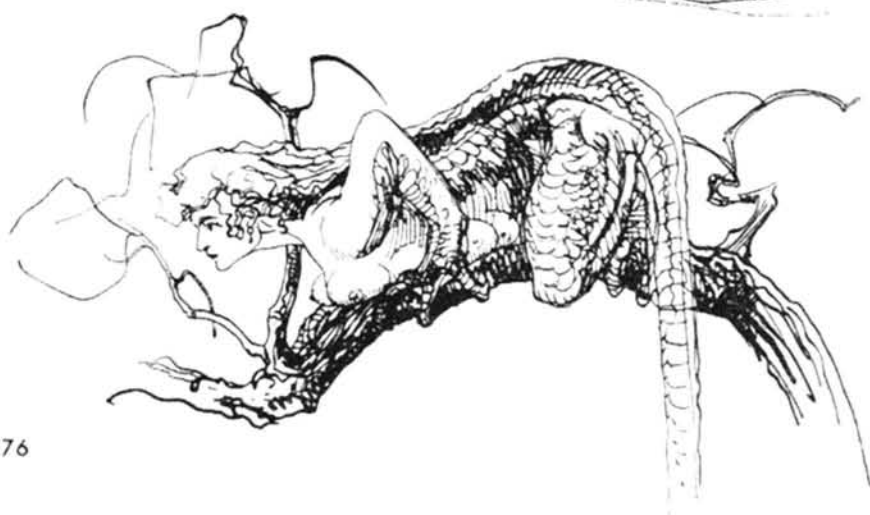


Bazaar Furies
Basarfurien



Auntie Tells a Fairy Tale
Märchentante







Business Is Bad
Schlechte Geschäfte



High Horsemanship
Hohe Schule







Almost Every Inch a Gentleman
Fast jeder Zoll ein Kavalier

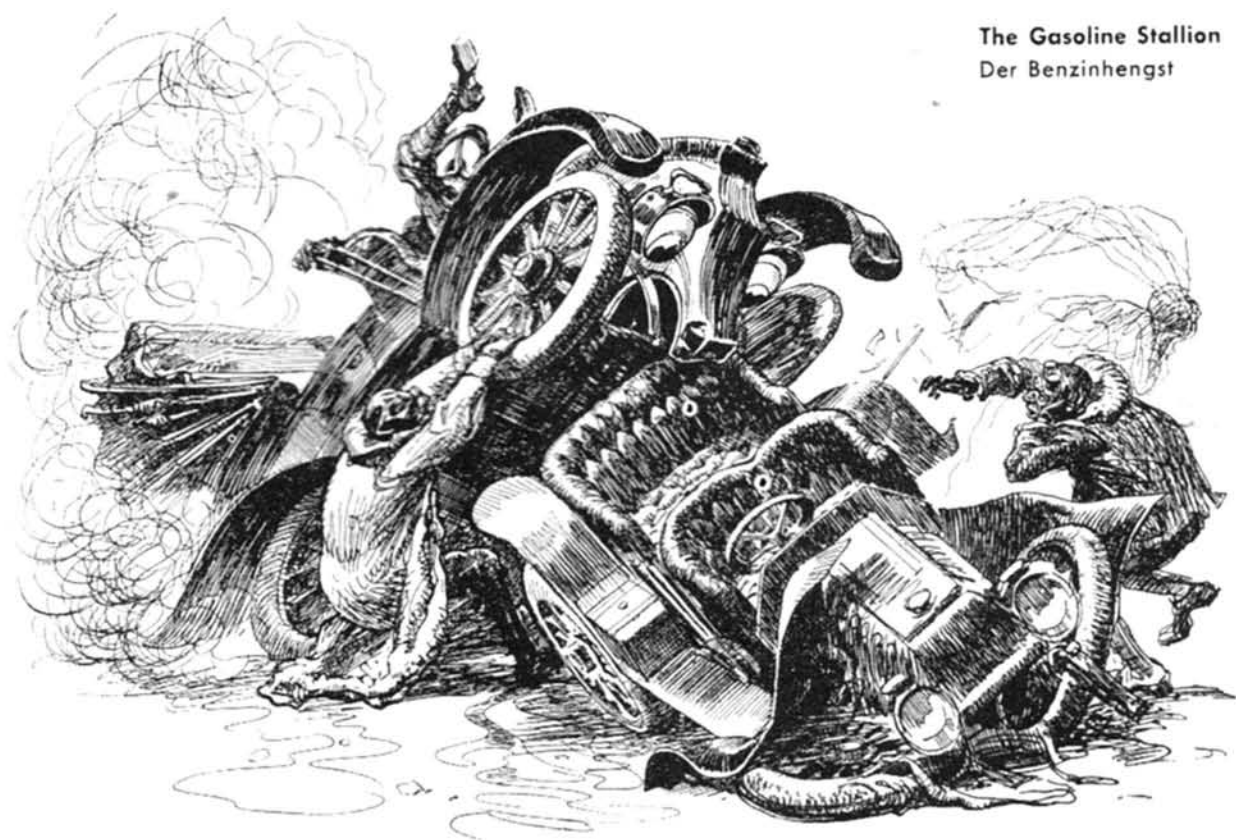


Ballast
Ballast



Asylum for Cold-water Cures
Kaltwasserheilanstalt

The Gasoline Stallion
Der Benzinhengst





"Pardon me—how do I get to the YMCA?"

"Pardon—wie komm ich hier am nächsten zum
Vereinshaus christlicher junger Männer?"



Fruit Fair
Obsthandel



The Handstand
Der Handstand





Bucolic Intermezzo
Schäferstündchen



The Workman's Compensation Patient
Der Kassenpatient





Giant's Toy
Riesenspielzeug



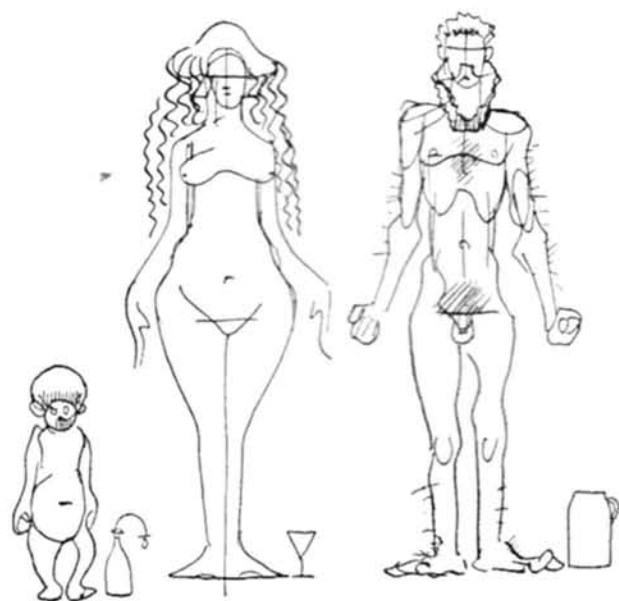


Popocatepetl
Popocatepetl*

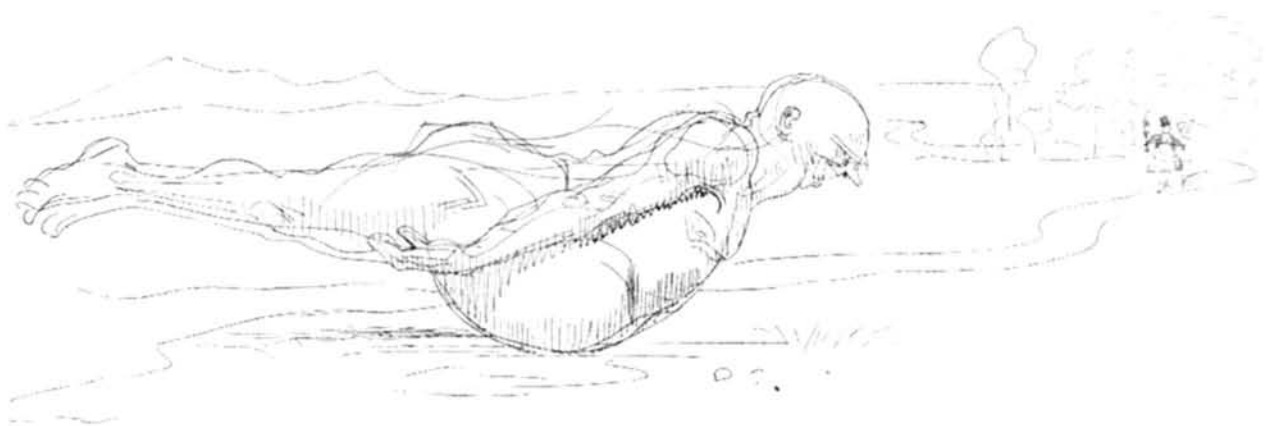
*Popocatepetl is a volcano in Mexico.
†The sign on the figure reads, "Families can cook their coffee here."



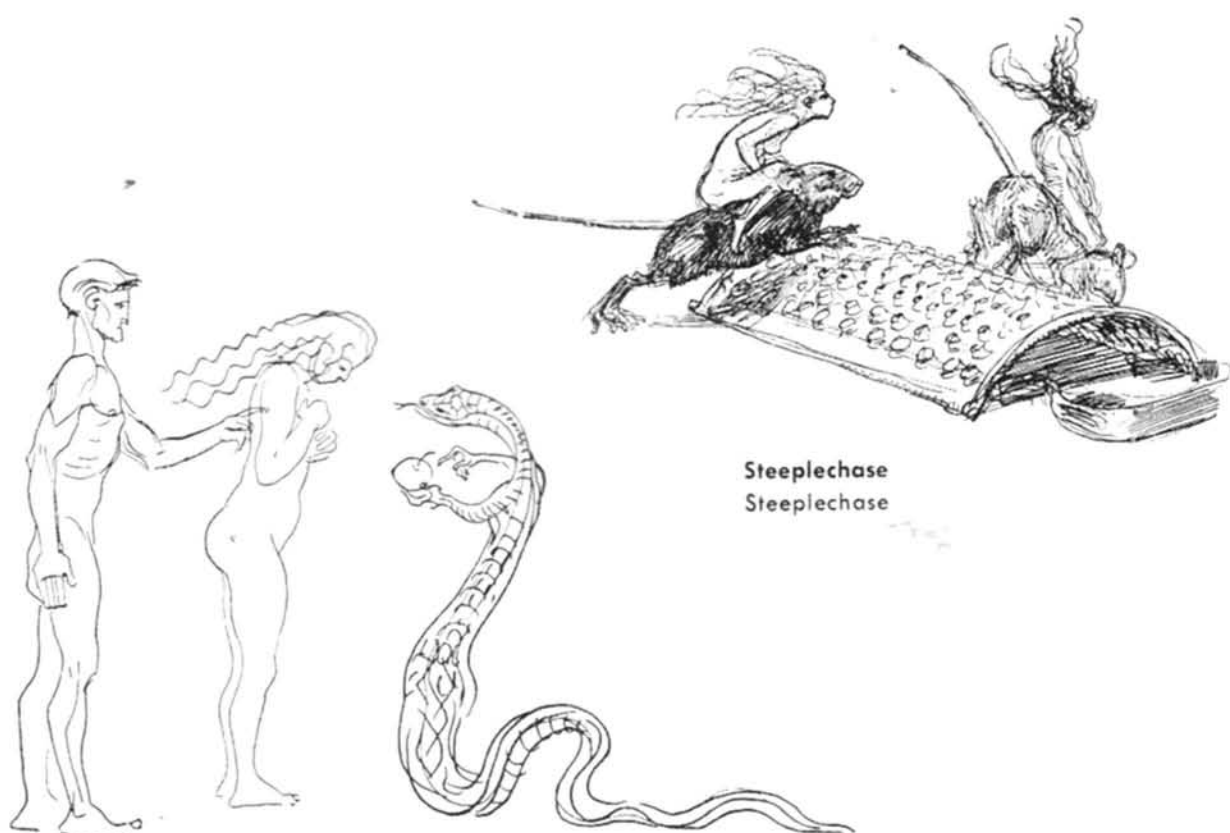
Training
Training



Grand House Clearing
Kehraus



Little Seesaw Man
Das Waggännle



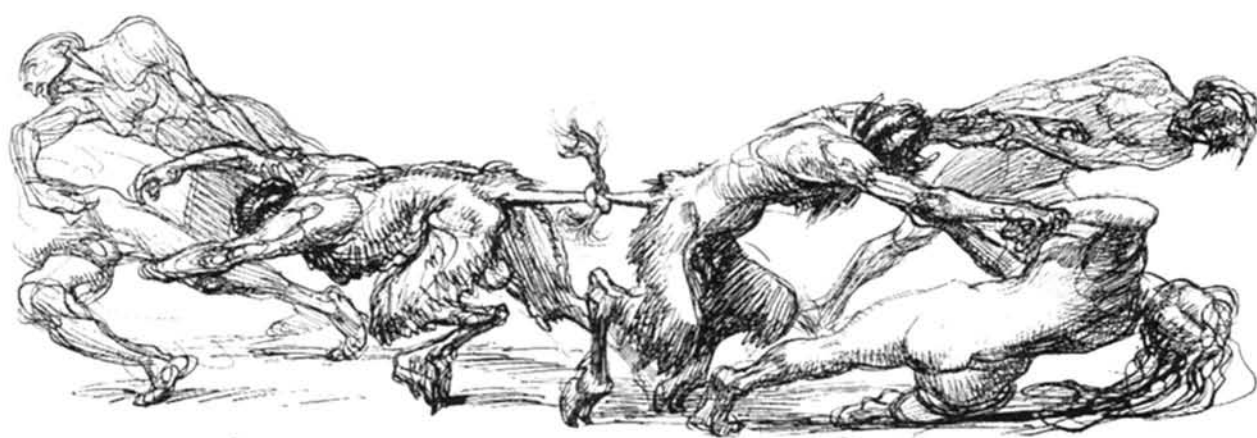
Grand Ball of the Diocese
Diözesanball



Human Shish Kebab
Menscherln à la fourchette



The End Hallows the Means
Der Zweck heiligt das Mittel



Tug of War
Tauziehen



*The sign above the door reads, "Marriage License Bureau."



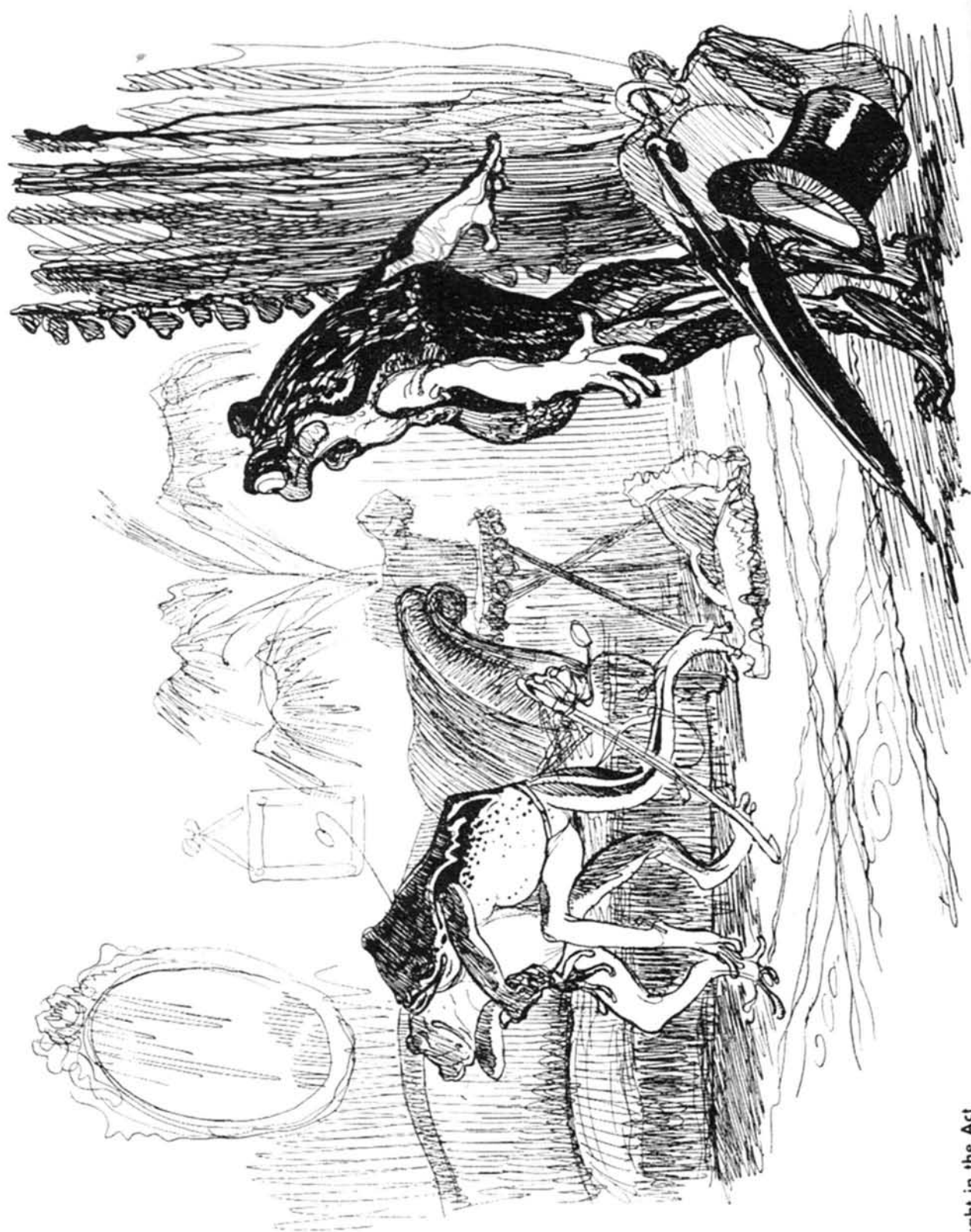
The Traveller on a Pleasure Trip
Der Vergnügungsreisende



Final Spurt
Endspurt



The Navy Chaplain
Der Marinepfarrer

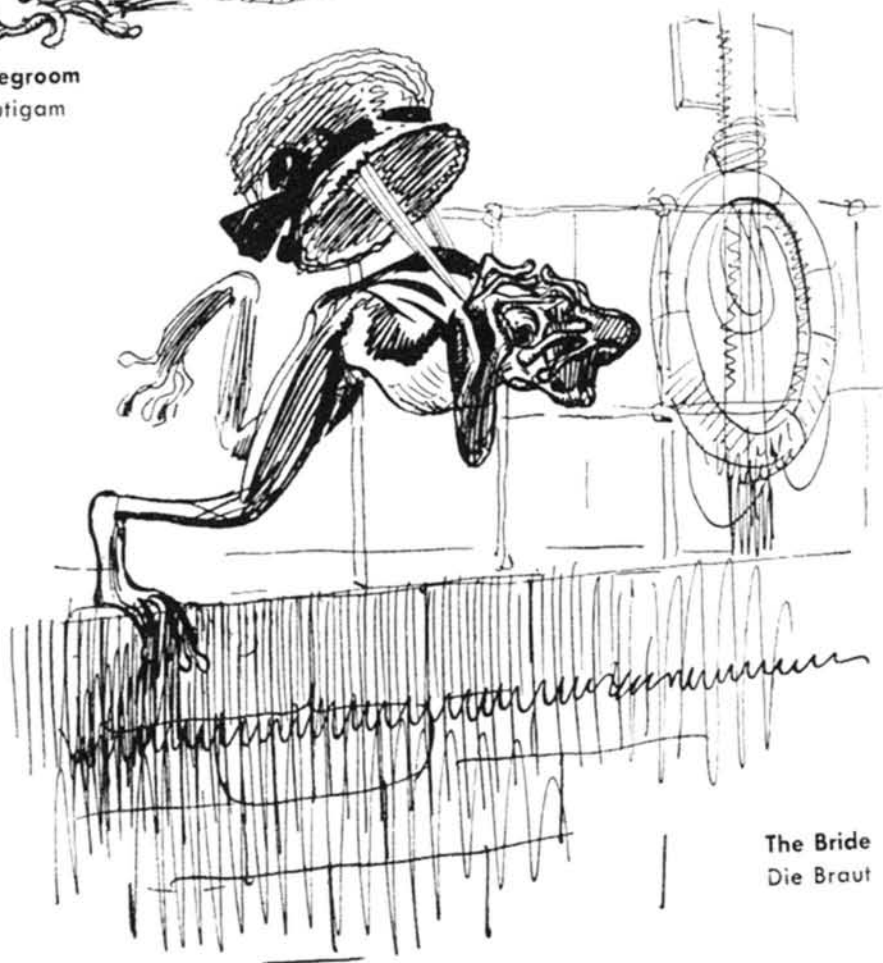


Caught in the Act
In flagranti





The Bridegroom
Der Bräutigam



The Bride
Die Braut

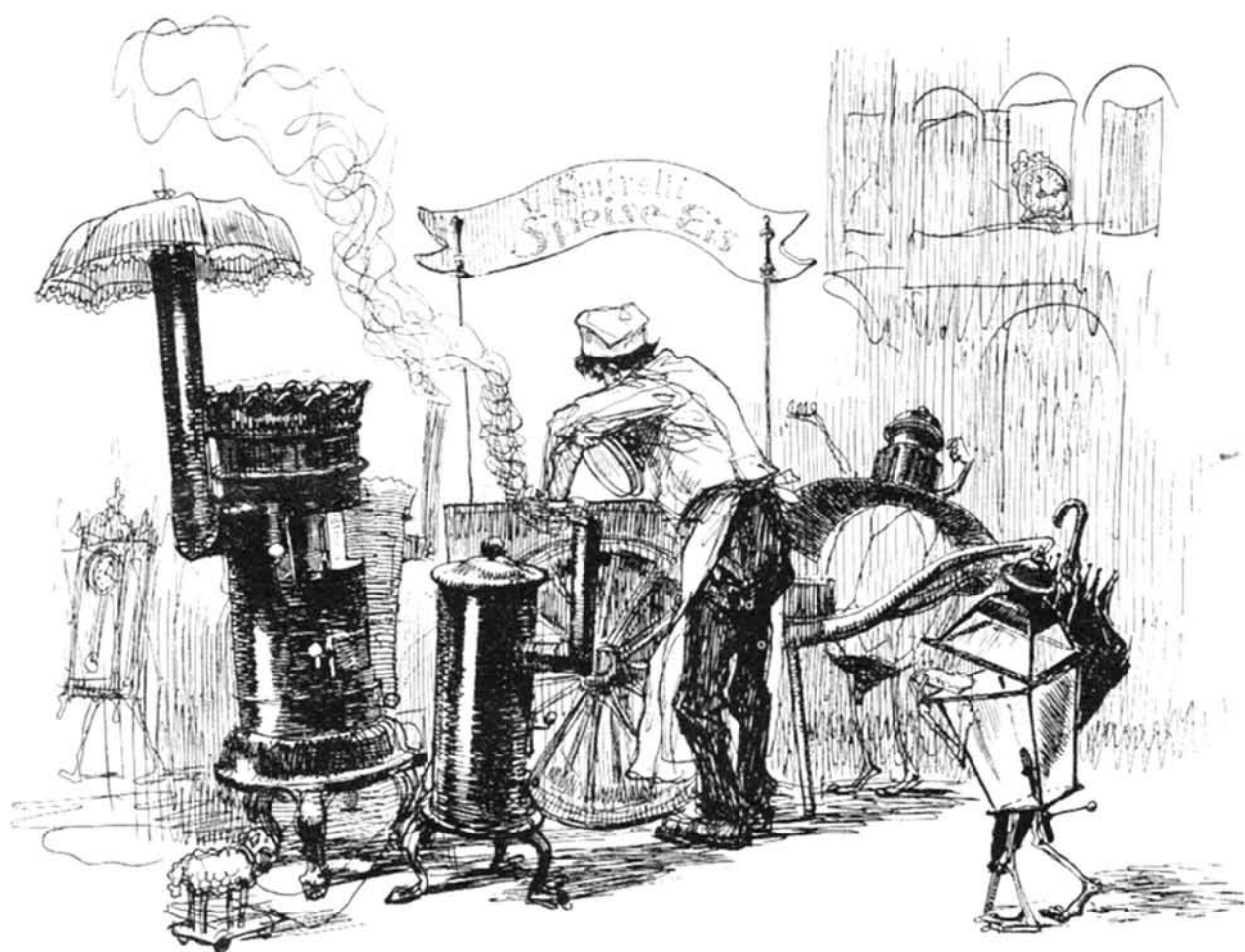


Tourist Season in Munich
Fremdensaison in München





On the Skating Rink
Auf der Eisbahn



Stoves with a Sweet Tooth
Naschende Oefen

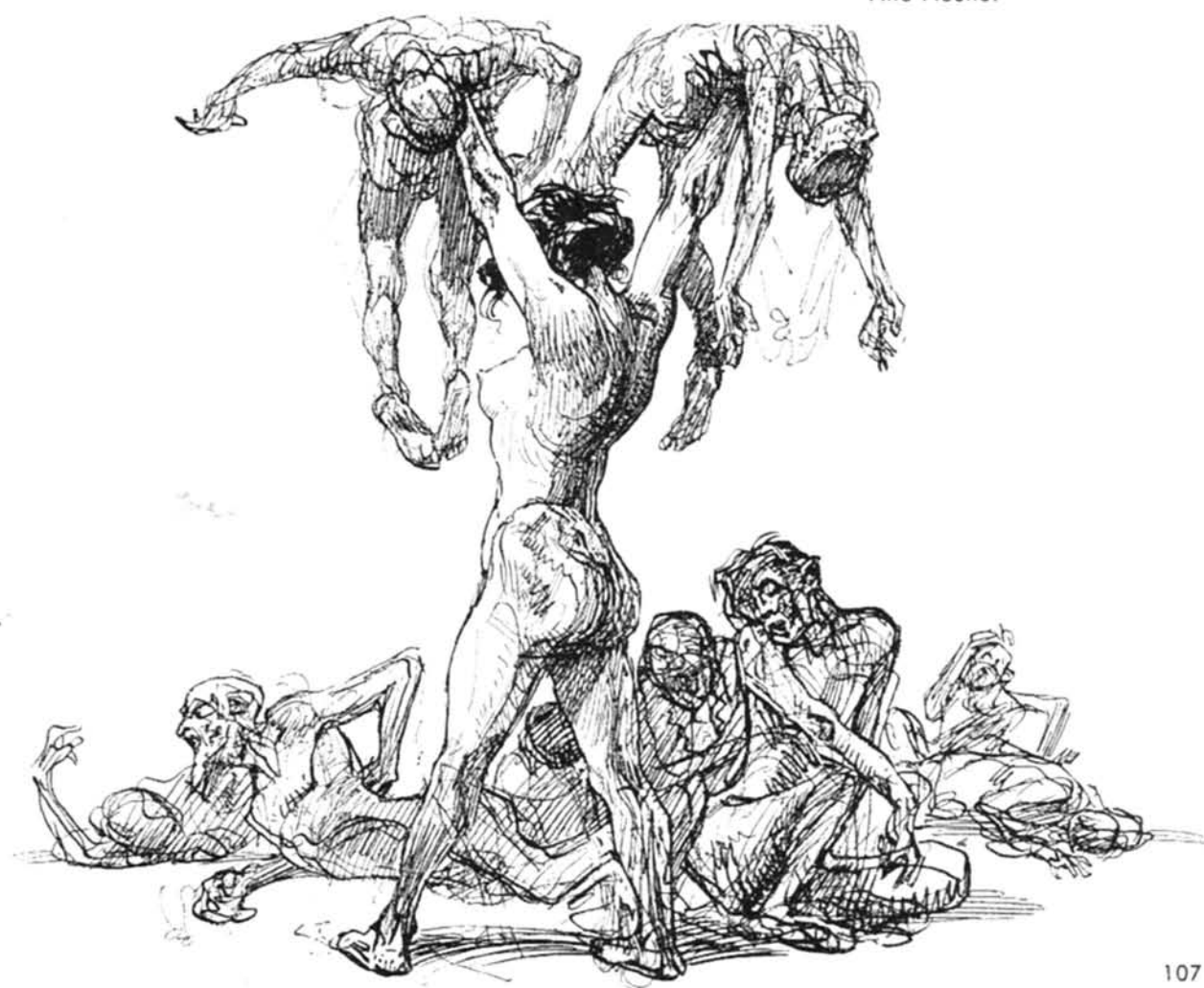
*The sign above the cart reads, "V. Smirelli Ice Cream."



Ladies' Gym Group
Damenriege



Strike! All Nine Pins Are Down!
Alle Neune!





Cloudburst
Platzregen

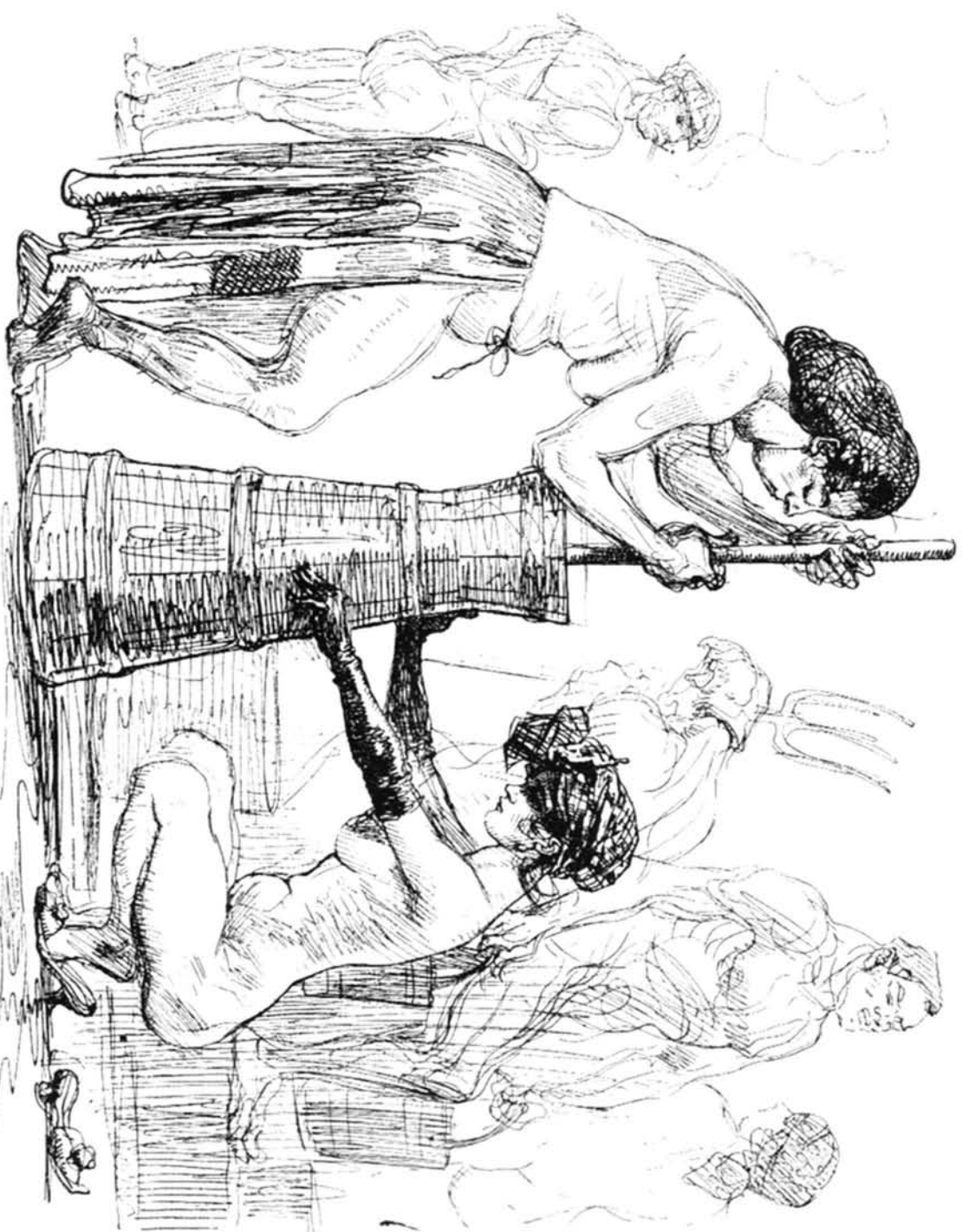


The Parasol
Der Sonnenschirm



Like Cures Like
*Similia similibus**

*The complete Latin expression is *Similia similibus curantur* (lit. Like [ailments] are cured by like.)



Girls at the Butter Churn

Mädchen am Butterfass



The Politicians
Die Politiker





Street Race
Strassenrennen



The Open Sandwich
Das belegte Brot



The Metaphysician
Der Metaphysiker



The Child Prodigy
Das Wunderkind





Mrs. Cook
Mrs. Cook





The Ivory Tusk
Das Elfenbein

*The sign above the door reads, "Municipal Pawn-shop" (Städtische Pfandleihe Anstalt).

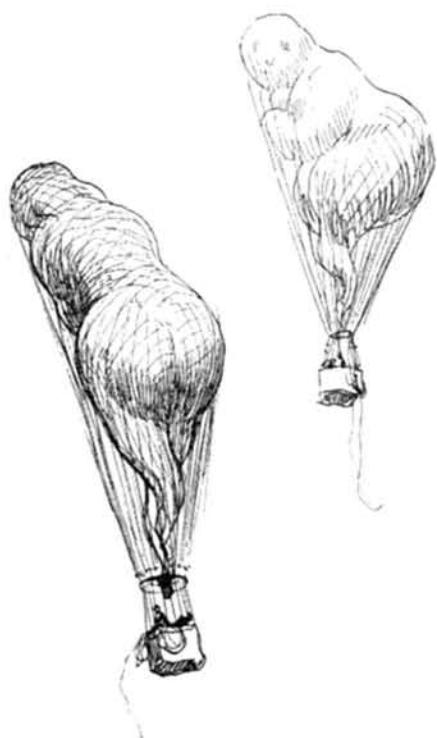
How Shall I Tell My Child?
Wie sag ich's meinem Kinde?



Ju Jitsu
Dschiu Dschitsu



Seashore Idyll
Strandidyll



Getting a General, Well-rounded View
Allgemeine Rundschau*

*Allgemeine Rundschau refers to a German periodical of that name. Rundschau can also mean an overall survey, in this case as afforded by a high-flying balloon.

Adagio
Adagio



The Train
Die Schiene



England Victorious
England siegt



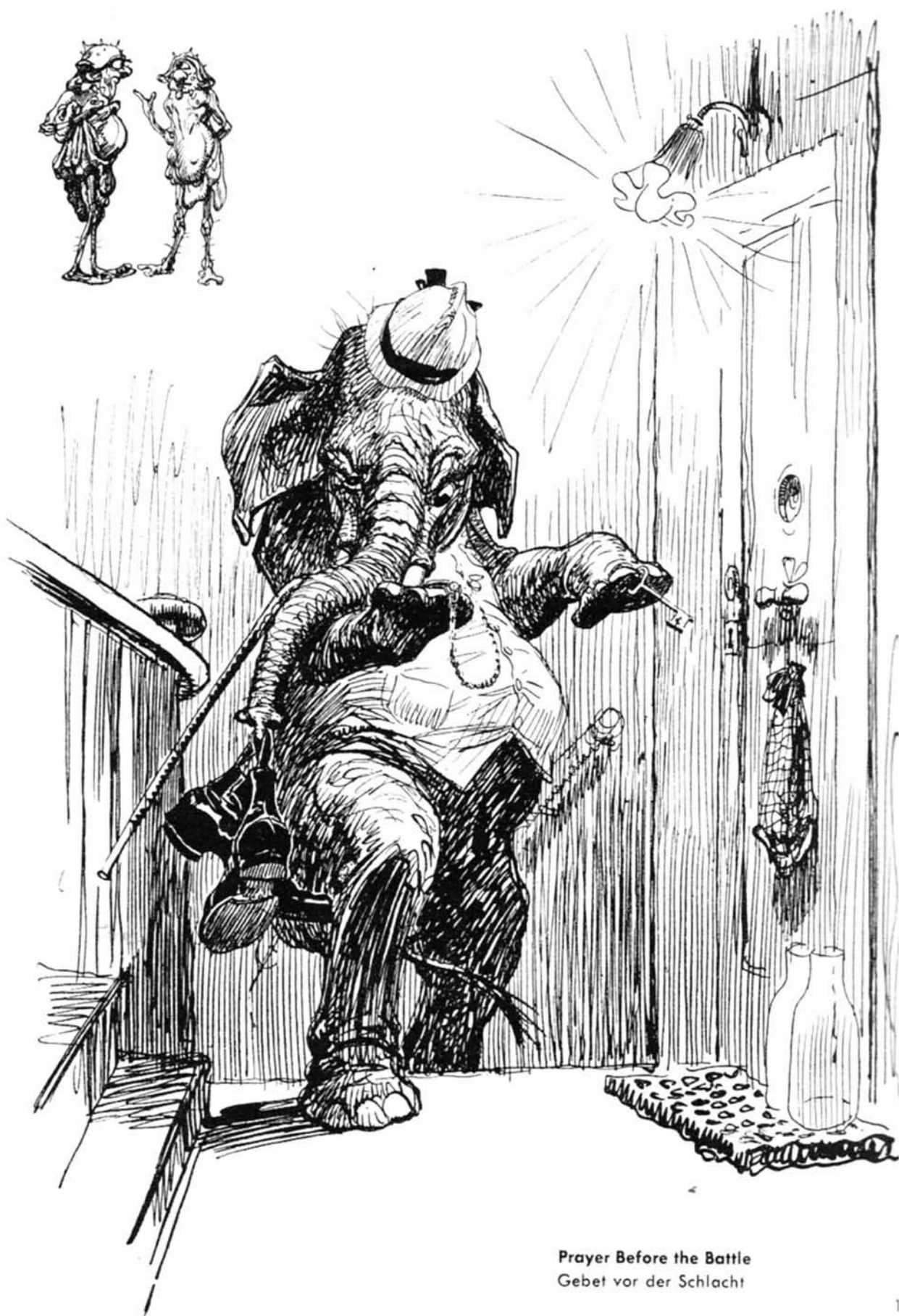
The Maiden's Prayer
Das Gebet der Jungfrau



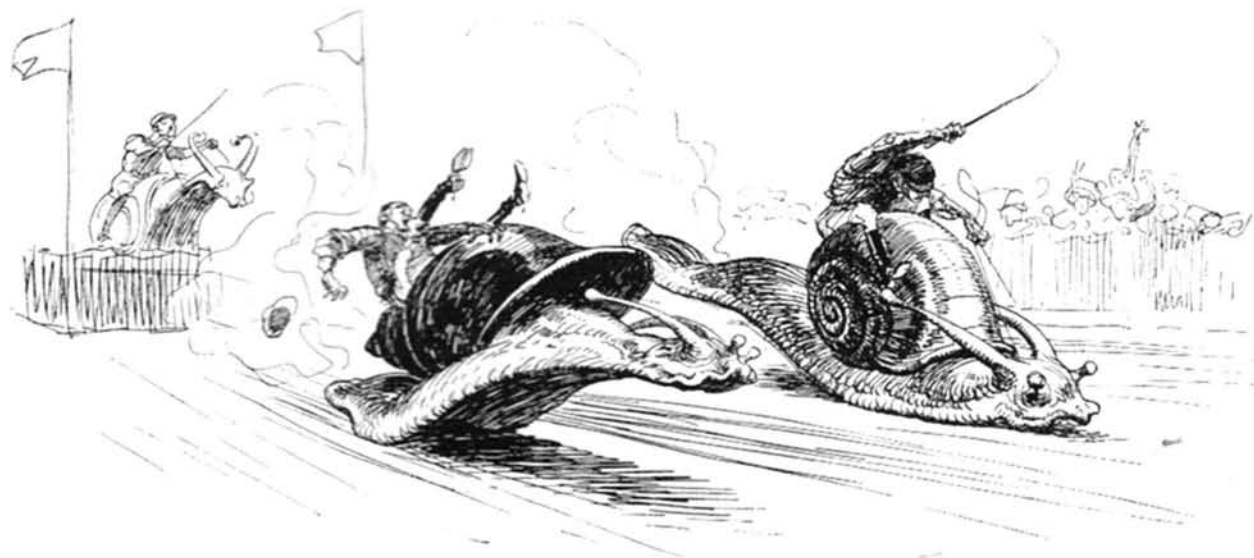
Potiphar's Wife
Frau Potiphar



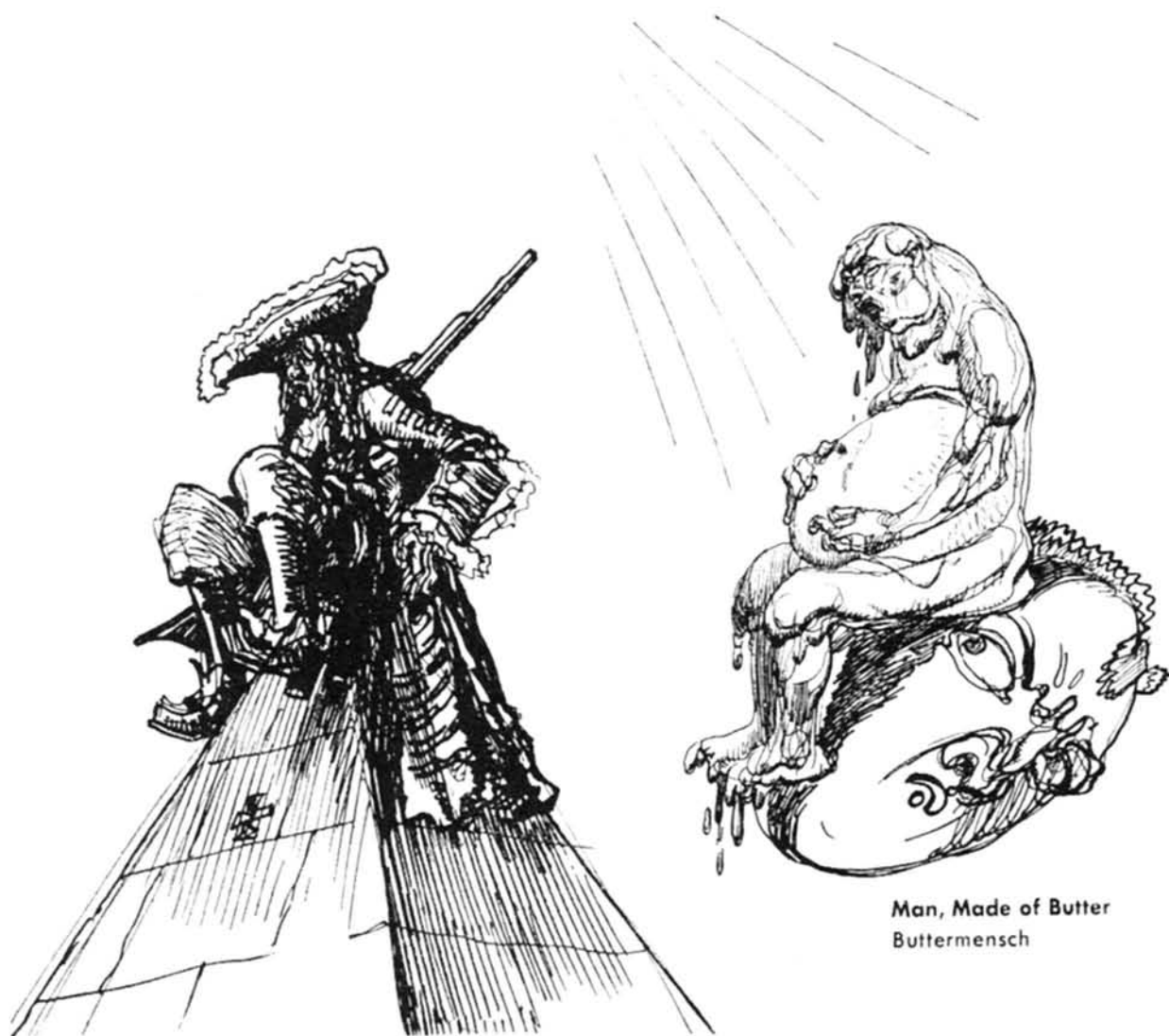
The Son-in-law
Der Schwiegersohn



Prayer Before the Battle
Gebet vor der Schlacht

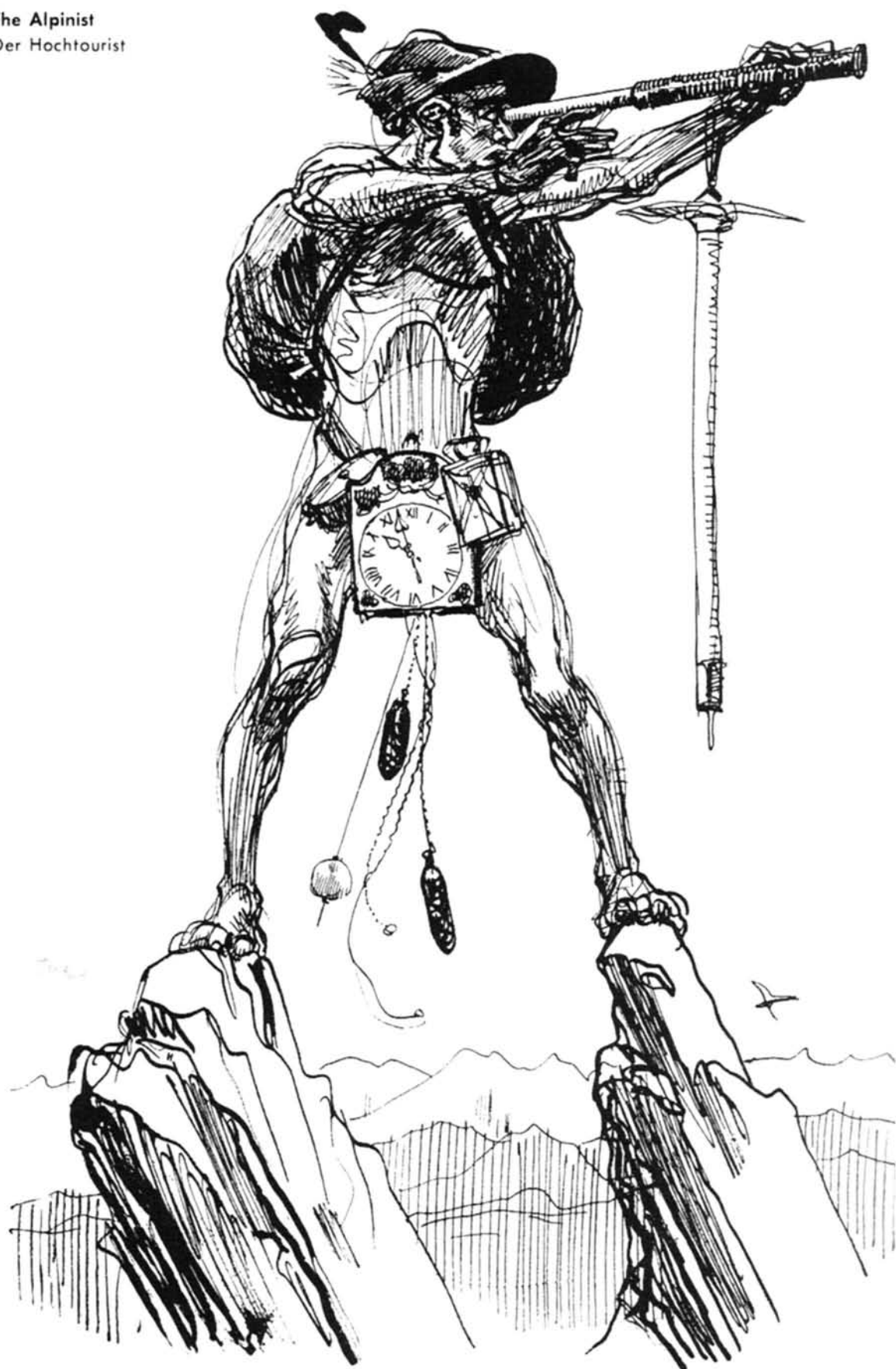


The Finish at the Snails' Race
Schneckenfinish



Man, Made of Butter
Buttermensch

The Alpinist
Der Hochtourist





Dance Craze
Tanzpest



Aunt Mina
Tante Mina